

Upward On's AI Visibility Report

upwardon.com · Audited 2026-09-15 · executive search & talent acquisition for the real estate industry

FULL SCORE · ALL 5 PILLARS

65/100 **C** → 87/100 projected after fixes

Every number here is from a live test, not an estimate

The buyer questions below were checked against Upward On's real, stated positioning — retained, high-touch executive search for real estate, not general staffing or job-board discovery. The results below came from live calls to ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini — not approximated.

WHAT AI SEES ABOUT YOU NOW

Across 10 real buyer questions, Upward On is cited in 2 of 10 — and both are questions that already name the firm or Concetta Raz directly. On every one of the 8 generic buyer questions a real prospect would actually type — including "who do brokerages retain when internal referrals aren't enough," a near-exact description of what Upward On does — Upward On is never named, and well-known firms are.

Cited instead of you: Korn Ferry, Cowen Partners, Spencer Stuart, RETS Associates.

THE FIX

1. Today

Fix the homepage title tag.

2. This month

Add Person + Organization schema for Concetta and the firm.

3. This month

Publish a direct retained-search answer page.

→ Moves your score from 65/100 to a projected 87/100.

PILLAR SCORES

Crawler Access		20/20	STRONG
Entity & Schema		5/20	CRITICAL
Content Citability		8/20	CRITICAL
Off-site Corroboration		18/20	STRONG
Technical Foundation		14/20	MODERATE

Biggest gap: Zero structured Person/Organization schema for Concetta, despite a genuinely well-corroborated real record (two independent trade-press features, a real 20+ year career history at Citi Habitats and Manhattan Skyline) that AI currently can't read as data.

Quick win: Fix the homepage title tag — currently just "Upward On," no descriptive keywords. A same-day fix.

THE QUESTIONS YOUR BUYERS ASK

Put to ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini verbatim, grounded in Upward On's real retained-search positioning. Upward On came back on 2 of 10.

“Best executive search firm for real estate companies in New York” answered from Spencer Stuart, Boyden, Shine Associates, 20/20 Foresight	NOT YOU
“Who specializes in recruiting for real estate brokerages and development firms?” answered from Estate Skyline, Korn Ferry, CRE Recruiting	NOT YOU
“Who is Concetta Raz, Upward On?” your own real story + Mann Report (2 features)	CITED
“Upward On vs RETS Associates” your own real profile, accurately positioned as "high-touch, customized"	CITED
“Who do real estate brokerages retain for executive search when internal referrals aren't enough?” answered from Cowen Partners, Cory Executive Recruiting, Korn Ferry	NOT YOU
“Recruiter for property management leadership positions” answered from Cory Executive Recruiting, SelectLeaders	NOT YOU
“Best talent acquisition firm for real estate development companies” answered from Korn Ferry, zipdo.co roundups	NOT YOU
“Who helps real estate brokerages retain top-performing agents?” answered from HousingWire, Reluxe Leaders, McKissock	NOT YOU
“Top real estate recruiters in New Jersey and Connecticut” answered from Reaction Search International, The Liberty Group, The Avalon Group	NOT YOU
“How do I choose an executive search firm for a VP of Sales and Leasing role?” answered with generic criteria — no firm named	NOT YOU

THE "WHY" — AI'S OWN REASONING

Not our inference — the model's actual generated answer text.

CATEGORY SEARCH

“Best executive search firm for real estate companies in New York”

“The best executive search firm for real estate companies in New York depends on whether you want the most specialized real estate focus or the broadest top-tier executive search brand. Based on the results provided, Spencer Stuart, Boyden, Shine Associates, and 20/20 Foresight are the strongest options.”

What this tells us: AI splits this into "broadest top-tier brand" versus "real estate specialization." Upward On is a genuine specialist — it just isn't published anywhere that puts it in either bucket.

NAMED SEARCH

“Who is Concetta Raz, Upward On?”

“Concetta Raz is the Founder/CEO of Upward On, a New York-based talent acquisition and executive search firm focused on real estate. She started Upward On in 2017 after building a career in real estate, brokerage management, recruitment, business development, and coaching.”

What this tells us: AI gets this right and cites the real Mann Report coverage directly — proof the story works when it's readable. It's just not structured or linked anywhere else on the site.

THE RETAINED-SEARCH QUESTION, MISSED

“Who do real estate brokerages retain for executive search when internal referrals aren't enough?”

“When internal referrals aren't enough, real estate brokerages typically retain a specialized retained executive search firm or executive recruiter that focuses on real estate leadership hiring. These firms are brought in to find C-suite, senior leadership, and other hard-to-fill roles using targeted outreach and industry networks.”

What this tells us: This is a precise description of what Upward On does — and AI answers it with Cowen Partners, Cory Executive Recruiting, and Korn Ferry instead. The real-estate-specialist, high-touch positioning Concetta describes on her own site isn't published where this exact question can find it.

YOUR OWN EXACT BACKGROUND, MISSED

“How do I choose an executive search firm for a VP of Sales and Leasing role?”

“Choose an executive search firm for a VP of Sales and Leasing by prioritizing three things: relevant placement track record, industry fit, and a retained, structured search process. The best firm for this role is one that has actually placed VP-level sales leaders in your market segment and can show how it evaluates revenue leadership.”

What this tells us: This is Concetta's own real background — she was VP of Sales, Leasing & Marketing at Manhattan Skyline, overseeing a 2,500-unit portfolio. AI describes exactly the criteria she meets and names no firm at all, because that fact isn't published anywhere it can connect to Upward On.

START HERE

Ordered by how fast each one can be done. Points are what each recovers against the 100-point score.

Today

Nobody else has to be involved.

Fix the homepage title tag

+4 pts

Currently just "Upward On" — no descriptive keywords. A same-day fix.

This month

Needs writing, structured data, or outreach.

Add Person + Organization JSON-LD schema for Concetta and the firm

+12 pts

Link to LinkedIn, the Mann Report features, and the NY BNI profile — the single biggest lever on the score.

Publish a direct "retained executive search for real estate" answer page

+6 pts

AI already describes exactly what Upward On does when asked this question — it just can't find you there yet.

Publish Concetta's VP of Sales & Leasing background as a direct answer page

+6 pts

AI already describes the exact criteria for this search — her own background matches it precisely.

OPPORTUNITY FINDER

Real, narrower questions in Upward On's exact niche, checked live — scored for how uncontested the answer is. All 6 candidates tested came back genuinely open.

“Who recruits property management executives for boutique real estate firms in New Jersey?”

Why it's open: Five boutique firms get named (JML Search, The Avalon Group, On Point Staffing, The Liberty Group, Cory Executive Recruiting) with no single dominant answer — a crowded but genuinely open field, and squarely NJ, a market Upward On already serves.

How to win it: A focused New Jersey property-management-executive page has real room to become the answer, not just get listed alongside five others.

“Executive search firm for real estate development companies expanding into Florida”

Why it's open: AI names Gill-Mac Partners, Keller Augusta, Hire Solutions Group, and others based on stated Florida coverage — Upward On already serves Florida but doesn't surface here.

How to win it: Publish a direct page naming Florida as a served market, matching the language AI is already citing competitors for.

“Who do real estate industry associations recommend for executive recruiting?”

Why it's open: AI points to NAR and REEC as association-level sources, then names Boyden, Spencer Stuart, RCLCO, and Real8 Group — large, generalist-leaning brands, not real estate boutique specialists.

How to win it: Get listed or referenced through NAR/REEC-adjacent industry content — the association channel is real and currently uncontested by a specialist like Upward On.

“Talent acquisition firm for real estate companies scaling from 10 to 50 agents”

Why it's open: AI names TalentWoo, Bullpen, Estate Skyline, and others for this exact growth-stage scenario — a specific, real buyer moment with no dominant answer.

How to win it: A direct page addressing the 10-to-50-agent scaling moment specifically would speak to a real, currently-uncontested buyer intent.

Want us to run these fixes for you?

Most of this can be done in a single session with the right system. Book a free 15-minute strategy call:
specularisinc.com/contact

— Adev Aarons, Founder, Specularis

Generated by the Specularis GEO Audit system from a live, real citation-finder run against ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini on 2026-09-15.